

Haircutting Robots: The Arrival of a New Scientific Frontier

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Mar. 4th 2026

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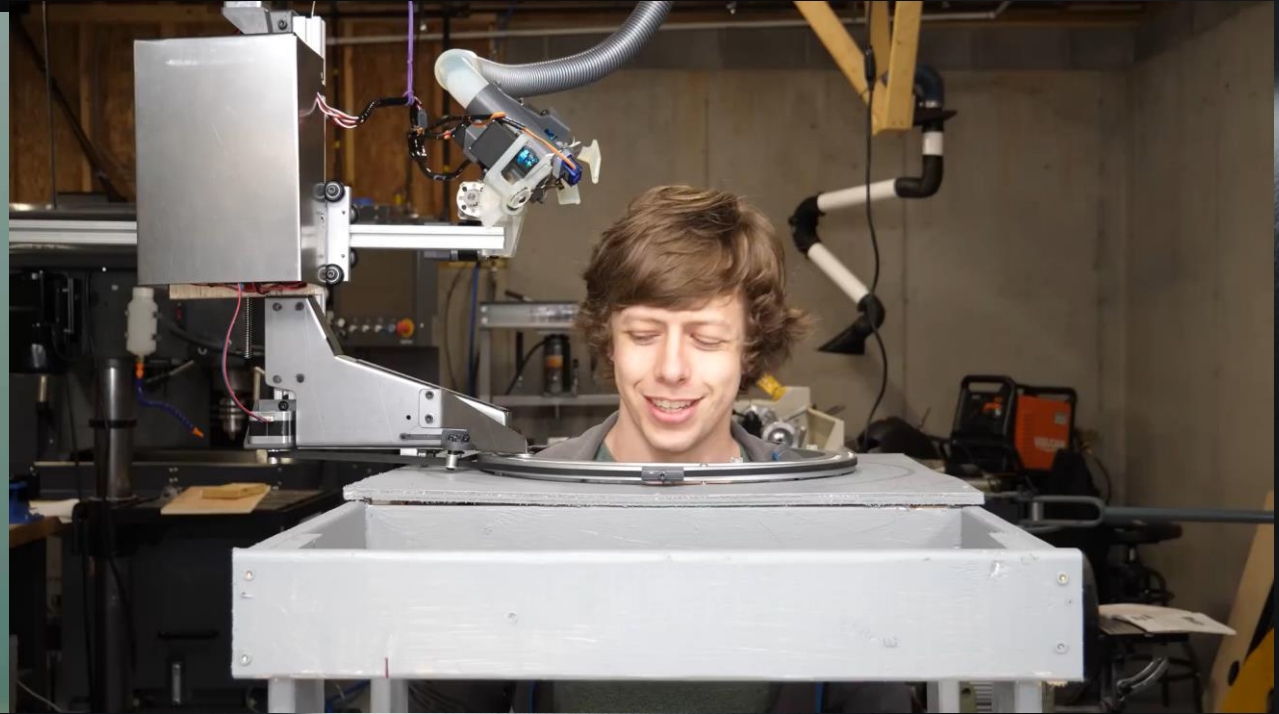


The background is a dark, cosmic scene. In the upper left, a portion of a planet with rings is visible. In the lower right, a large, bright, curved horizon of a planet dominates the frame. The background is filled with numerous small, distant stars.

01

Introduction & Motivation

Prototypes on Haircutting Robots



Prototypes on Haircutting Robots



STEP 1: 3D scan the neck using iPhoneX

Prototypes on Haircutting Robots



Imaginary Haircutting Robots



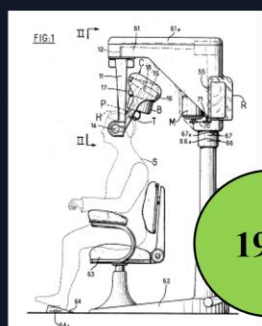
Robot ने काटे
Elon Musk के hair

Imaginary Haircutting Robots



Brief History of Haircutting Robots

The first patent on haircutting



1961

United States Patent Office

3,241,562
AUTOMATIC HAIR-CUTTING MACHINE HAVING
PROGRAMMED CONTROL MEANS FOR CUT-
TING HAIR IN A PREDETERMINED STYLE
Jean Gronier, 145 Blvd. de la Reine, Versailles, France
Filed Feb. 10, 1961, Ser. No. 88,409
Claims priority, application France, Feb. 16, 1960,
818,578; Feb. 1, 1961, 851,348
13 Claims. (Cl. 132-45)

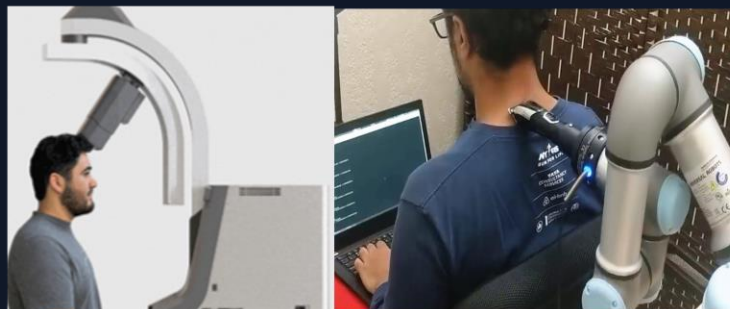
My invention has for its object a hair-cutting machine comprising means for the automatic cutting of hair in accordance with a predetermined program; each program is designed for a particular person and is established once and for all with a view to obtaining repeatedly the same cut for the same head. More specifically, the machine includes a frame, implements for cutting the hair, movable means connecting the instruments with the frame,

from above the array third change speed go FIG. 19 is a pers 18 of the same part FIG. 20 is a pers the connection bet and the casing carry FIGS. 21, 22, 23 third change speed ferent shafts formi FIG. 25 is a view the casing carrying in the direction of FIG. 26 is a dia gear system contri towards or away fro FIG. 27 is a long ment carrier.



Covid

A burst of DIY robotic haircutting



Conference special issue on haircutting robots

Special Session – Haircutting Robots: Intelligent Sensing, Dexterous Control, and Human-Centric Design

Scope and Objectives

As robotics expands into service industries, haircutting emerges as a uniquely challenging domain requiring human-like dexterity, personalization, and ergonomic consideration. These systems must navigate complex head geometries while ensuring user comfort, adapting to individual anthropometrics and maintaining safety in dynamic environments. Traditional robotic solutions, optimized for structured tasks, struggle with these contact-rich, ergonomically sensitive operations that demand adaptive precision and human-centric interaction.

Submission Guidelines

Papers submitted to this special session should follow the standard formatting and submission guidelines of ICNSC 2025 which can be found on the Submission page: <https://www.cdu.edu.au/icscsc2025/submission.html>.

During the submission process, authors should select this special session by title (Special Session on Haircutting Robots: Intelligent Sensing, Dexterous Control, and Human-Centric Design) to ensure their papers are directed appropriately.

Session Organizer

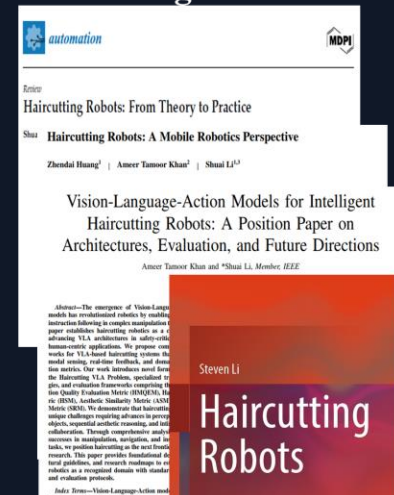
Session Organizer: Dr. Ata Jahangir Mohtashami, Associate Professor

Affiliation: School of

Engineering

2025

Scientific publications on haircutting robots



AI Video Generation

A burst of AI-generated videos on robotic haircutting



Keynote speech: IEEE 25th International Symposium on Computational Intelligence and Informatics (CINTI 2025) on November 18–20, 2025 in Budapest, Hungary.
Keynote speech: IEEE 2nd International Conference on Advanced Computing and Emerging Technologies (ACET 2025) on November 21, 2025.

Why Haircutting Robots Matter



Market Drivers

- Rising labor costs & barber shortages
- Demand for consistent, high-quality service
- 24/7 availability and enhanced hygiene



Robotic Solutions

- Create a new sector in automation
- Offer personalized, efficient experiences
- Address a massive, recurring market need

Rise of Affordable Robots



Then (Honda ASIMO)

~\$1.3M

Now (Unitree R1)

~\$5,900

This ~200x cost reduction unlocks new service sectors like haircutting, previously economically unfeasible.

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02

Market Opportunity

Urban Haircut Spending

Annual spending in major cities demonstrates strong local demand for automated solutions.

NYC annual market size: $4.125 \text{ million men} \times 12 \times 20\text{USD} \times 2 = 1.98 \text{ billion USD}$

~2.0

New York City
Billion USD

~9.0

Shanghai
Billion RMB

~3.5

London
Billion GBP

Global Market Estimate

Segmenting the global population reveals a massive market opportunity.

\$576B

High-Income
1.2B People

\$216B

Middle-Income
2.0B People

\$35B

Low-Income
1.45B People

Total Annual Global Market: ~\$827 Billion USD

Ref. S. Li, Haircutting Robots: From Theory to Practice, MDPI Automation

A dark space background featuring a large, bright, curved horizon of a planet or moon in the lower right. In the upper left, a ringed planet like Saturn is partially visible. The background is filled with numerous small, distant stars.

03

Prior Research

Computer Graphics Foundations

Table 1. Existing works on hair modeling and hair editing.

References	Tasks	Application to Haircutting Robots	Code Availability
[3]	Hair simulation	Hair preview	No
[4]	Hair 3D reconstruction	2D image to hair 3D model	https://github.com/hoseok-tong/NeuralHaircutTHS
[5]	Hair segmentation	Hair preview and recommendation	No
[6]	Hair 3D reconstruction from images	2D image to hair 3D model	https://github.com/papagina/Hair-Net DataSetGeneration
[7]	Hair 3D reconstruction from images	2D image to hair 3D model	No
[8]	CT based hair 3D reconstruction	CT based hair 3D model	https://github.com/facebookresearch/CT2Hair
[9]	Hair dynamic simulation	Hair preview	No
[11]	Image based hair style and color editing	Hair preview and recommendation	https://github.com/Zlin0530/Hair-Manip
[12]	Strand-based 3D hair model and hair style and color editing	Hair preview and recommendation	No
[13]	Video based dynamic image manipulation and editing	Hair preview and recommendation	No

Physically-based Strand Models

Simulate hair's dynamic behavior.

Single-View 3D Reconstruction

Create accurate hair models from images.

Dynamic Simulation

Enable realistic style preview.

Robotic Hair Manipulation

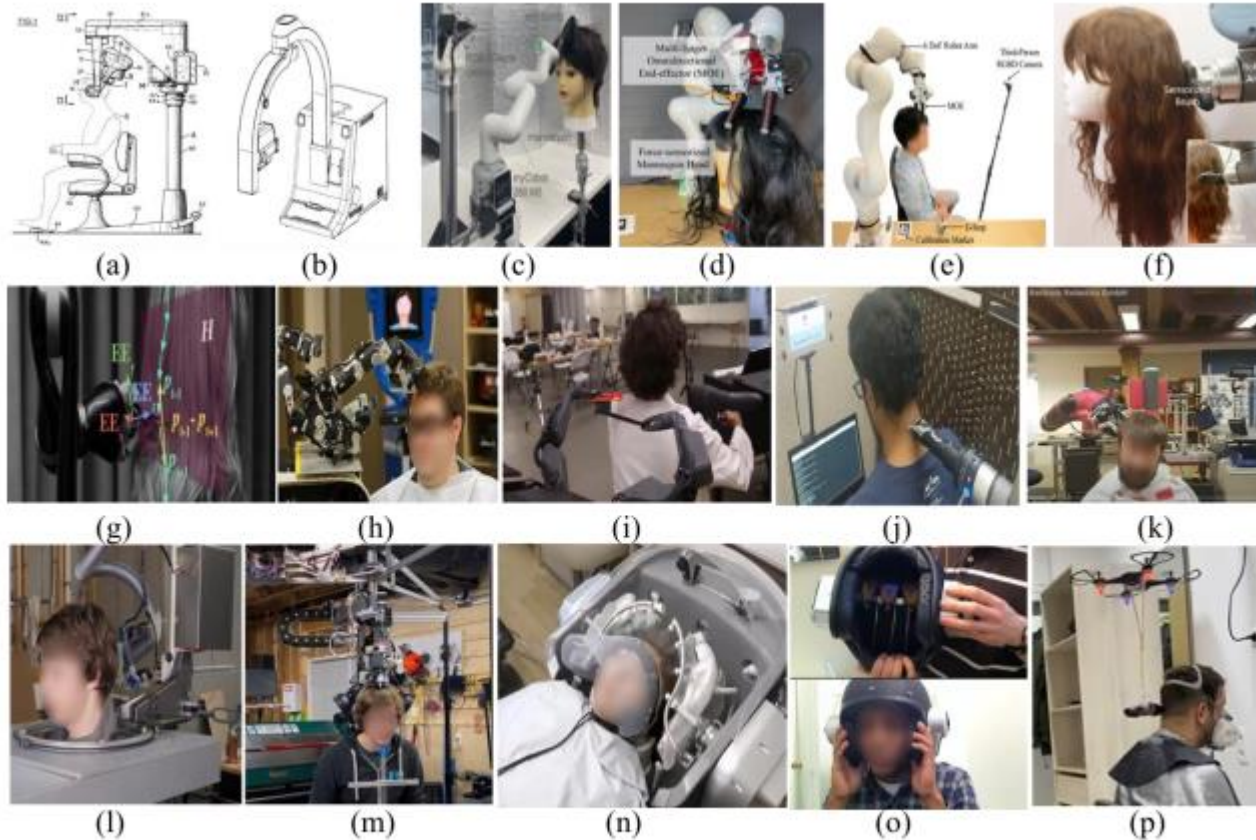


Figure. 1. Sixty-year of endeavor in human history towards haircutting robots [14,16-30]. (descriptions summarized in Table 1).

Table 2. Existing attempts towards haircutting robots.

References	No. in Fig. 1	Publication format	Type	Targeted area	Description
[14]	a	Patent	System development	Product	Mechanical and circuit design
[16]	f	Paper	Programming	Research	Coding on commercial robots with force feedback
[17]	e	Paper	Programming	Research	Coding on commercial robots with force feedback
[18]	d	Paper	System development	Research	Coding on self-developed soft gripper with commercial robots
[19]	c	Paper	Programming	Research	Coding on commercial robots for front hair styling
[20]	g	Paper	Programming	Research	Coding on commercial robots for vision-based hair combing
[21]	n	Paper	Research	Product	A commercial product by Panasonic Ltd for shampooing and scalp massaging
[22]	b	Patent	System development	Product	A commercial product by StudioRed Ltd for MyBarberRobot.
[23]	l	Video	System development	DIY	A vision-based DIY system for automated haircutting
[24]	m	Video	System development	DIY	A vision-based DIY system for automated haircutting
[25]	j	Video	Programming	DIY	iPhone scanning based automated haircutting using a commercial robot
[26]	k	Video	Programming	DIY	Automated haircutting using a collaborative robot
[27]	h	Video	Programming	DIY	Teleoperated haircutting
[28]	i	Video	Programming	DIY	Teleoperated haircutting
[29]	o	Video	Future	DIY	Imaginary haircutting helmet
[30]	p	Video	Future	DIY	Conceptual design with drones for haircutting

Refs. S. Li, Haircutting Robots: From Theory to Practice, MDPI Automation;
S. Li, Book: Haircutting Robots, Springer.

A dark space background featuring a large, bright, curved horizon of a planet or moon in the lower right. In the upper left, a ringed planet like Saturn is partially visible. The background is filled with numerous small, distant stars.

04

Technical Requirements

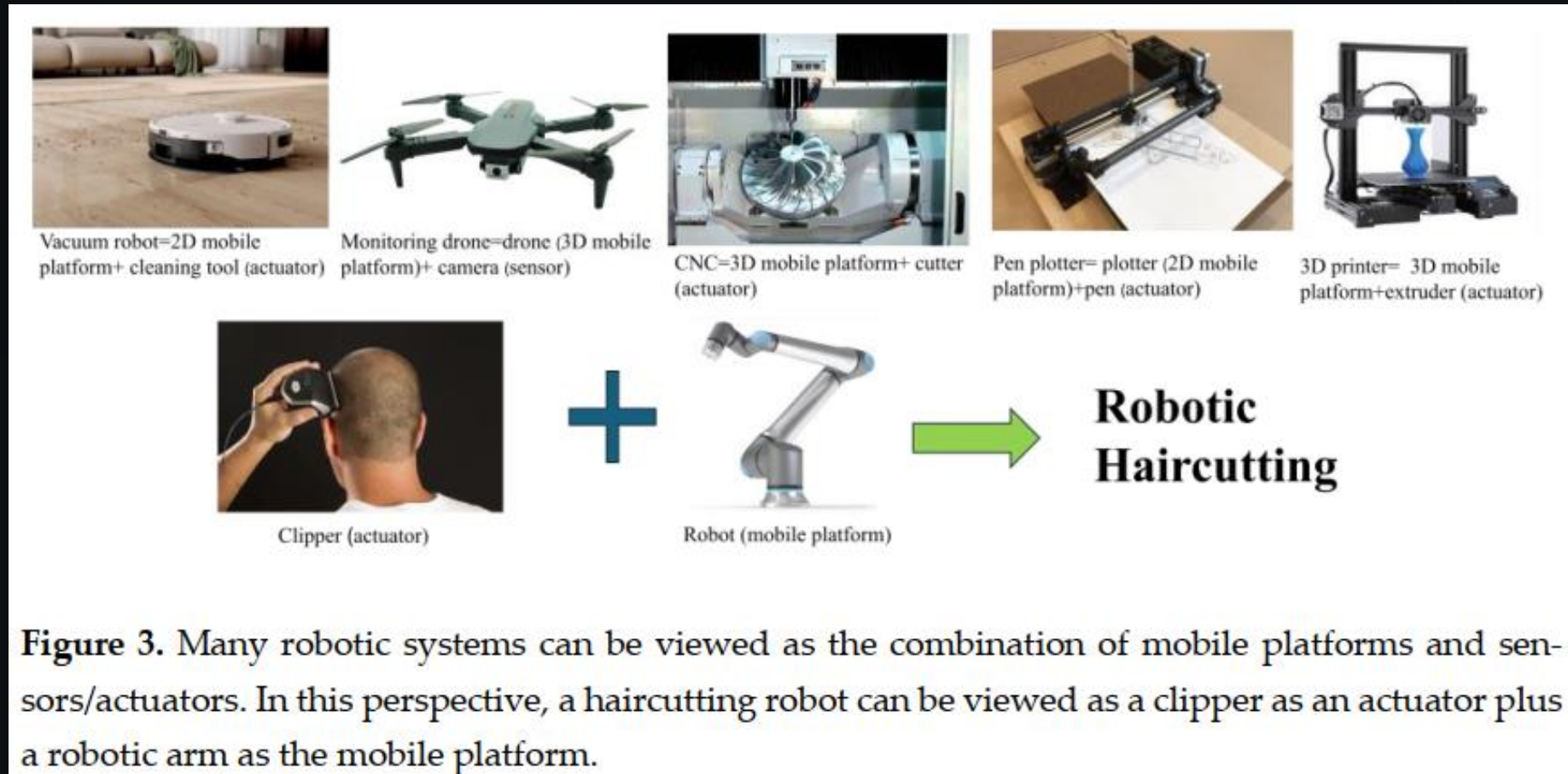
Teleoperated Cutting Needs

Remote operation must overcome fundamental **communication delays** to ensure stability and safety.



Figure 2. Teleoperated haircutting, which allows remote haircut of customers in metropolitan areas by barbers living in rural areas. (This figure is partially edited with Gemini 2.5 Flash).

Autonomous Haircutting



Refs. S. Li, Haircutting Robots: From Theory to Practice, MDPI Automation

A. Khan and S. Li Robotic Haircutting Systems: A Survey of Methods, Challenges, and Hair Modeling Insights, IEEE Journal of Selected Areas in Sensors.

Autonomous Cutting Pipeline



UFO Clipper

EVEN CUT™

Conair EVEN CUT is sold as
BaByliss[®] men EASY CUT
in Europe.

Products and operation
are identical, so watch
our BaByliss Easy Cut
video to see how the
Conair EVEN CUT works.

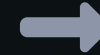
BaByliss[®]



Flowbee Clipper



Autonomous Cutting Pipeline: A CNC Perspective



1. Workpiece Definition

Treat head as a dynamic 3D object.

2. 5-Axis Toolpath Planning

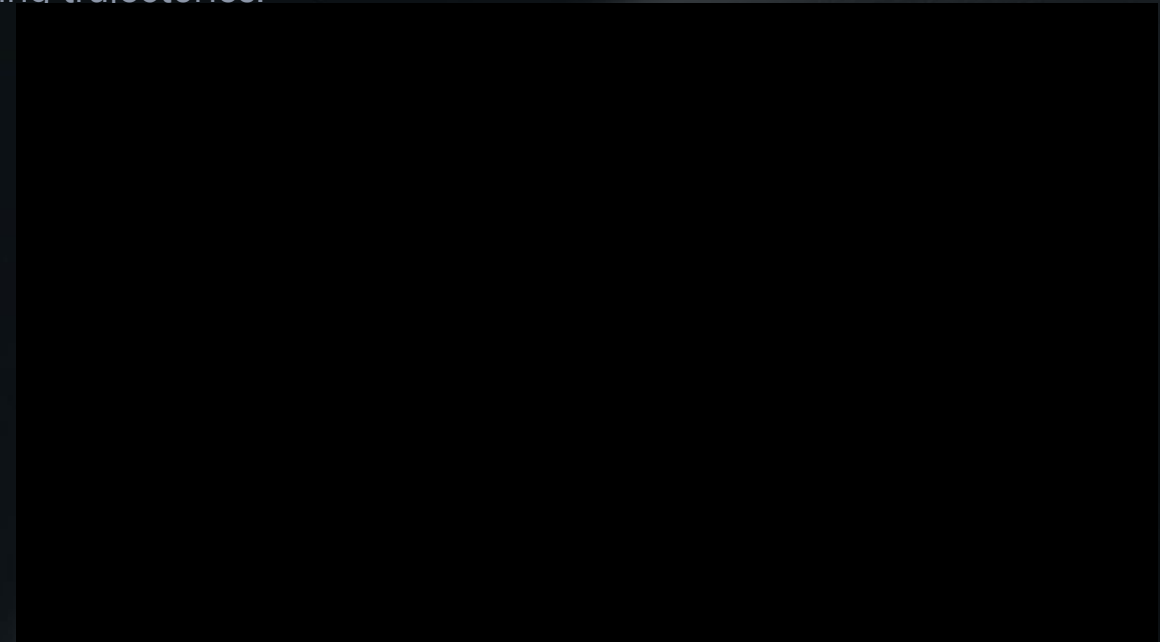
Generate precise cutting trajectories.

3. Real-Time Tracking

Adapt to head motion with visual servoing.

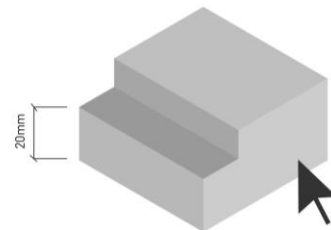
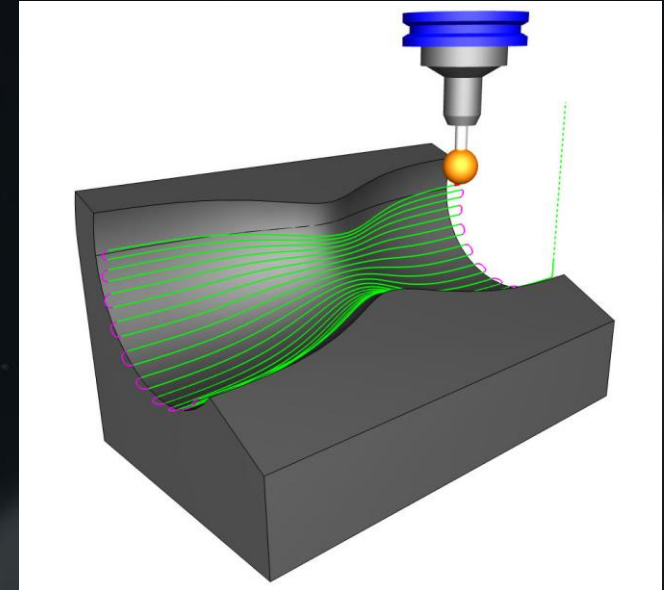


CNC for Sculpture

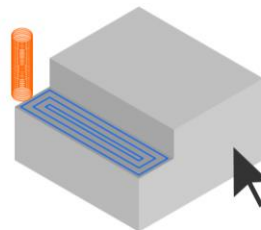


KUKA robot for wood carving

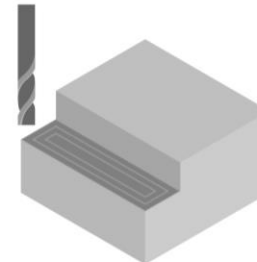
CNC Perspective



CAD
(Computer Aided Design)



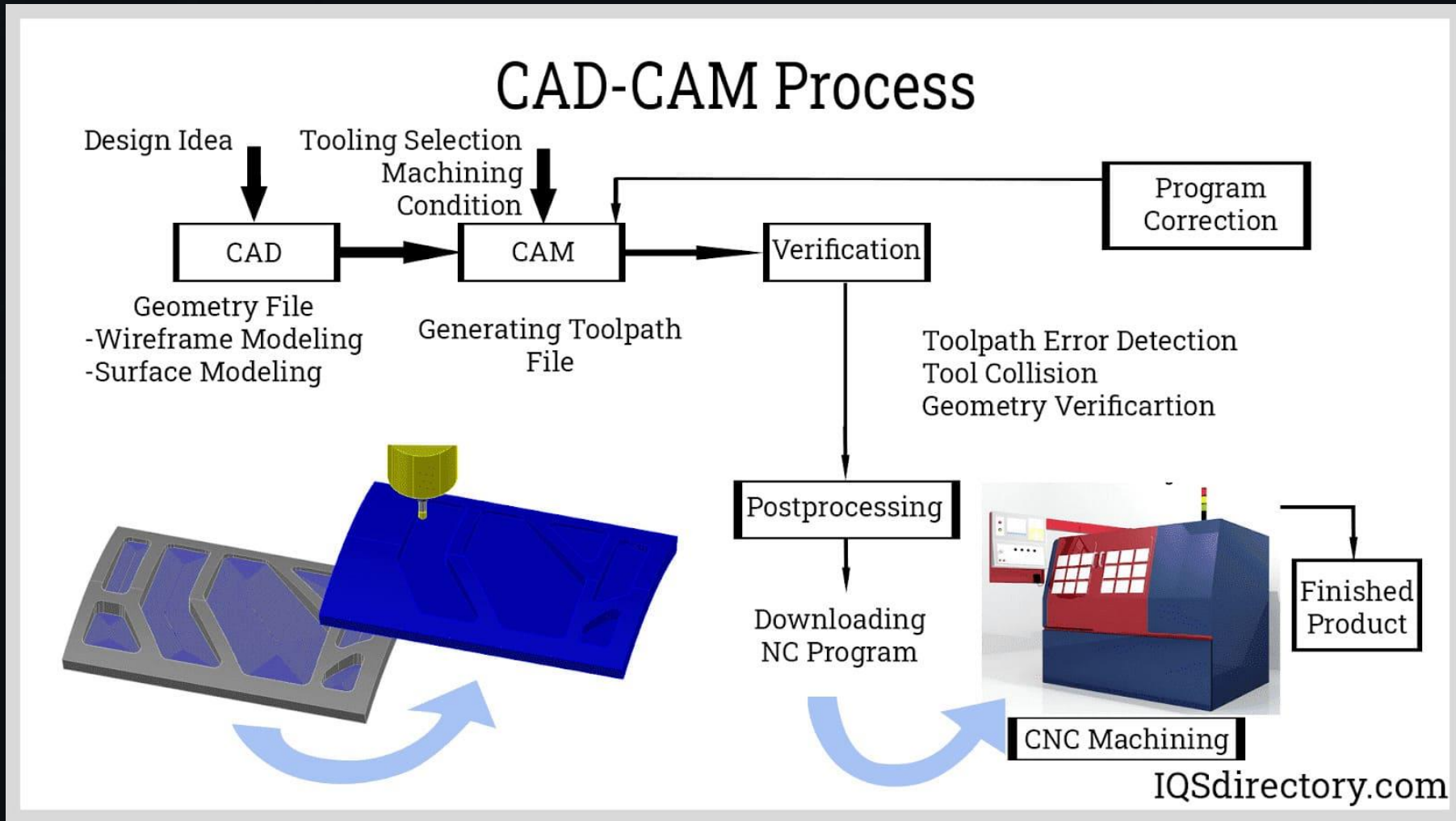
CAM
(Computer Aided Manufacture)



CNC
(Computer Numerical Control)

Ref: A. Khan and S. Li, CNC-Inspired Robotic Hair Cutting: A Comprehensive Survey on Precision Personal Care Automation, Journal of Artificial Intelligence for Automation

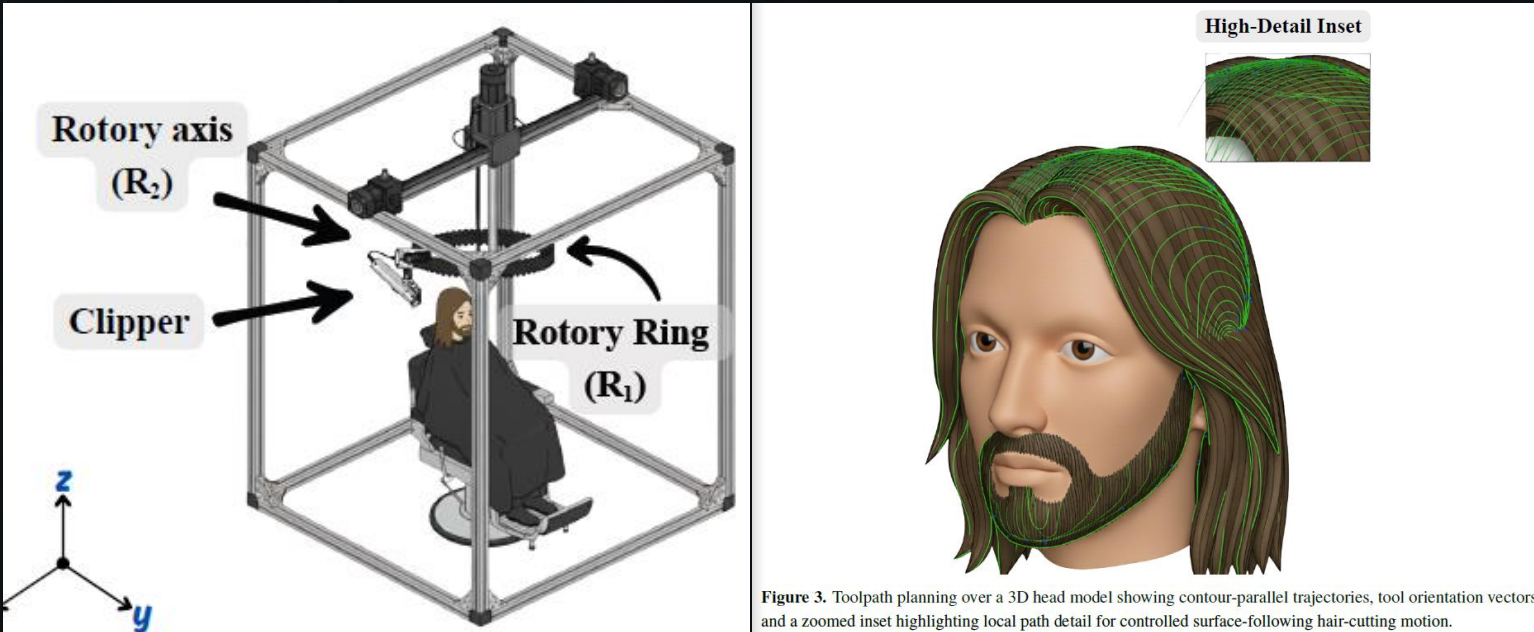
CNC Perspective



<https://www.iqsdirectory.com/articles/cnc-machining.html>

Ref: A. Khan and S. Li, CNC-Inspired Robotic Hair Cutting: A Comprehensive Survey on Precision Personal Care Automation, Journal of Artificial Intelligence for Automation

CNC Perspective



Algorithm 1 Multi-Pass Toolpath Generation

Require: Initial hair volume S_0 , Target hairstyle T , Safety zones O

Ensure: Sequence of toolpaths $\{g_i(t)\}_{i=1}^N$

- 1: Initialize residual volume $S \leftarrow S_0$
- 2: $i \leftarrow 0$
- 3: **while** $S \not\subseteq T^{+\epsilon}$ **do**
- 4: $i \leftarrow i + 1$
- 5: Compute removal target $R_i \leftarrow S \setminus T$
- 6: Generate collision-free toolpath $g_i(t)$ covering R_i
- 7: Verify $g_i(t) \cap O = \emptyset$ for all t
- 8: Execute pass and update $S \leftarrow S \setminus E_i$
- 9: **end while**
- 10: **return** $\{g_i(t)\}_{i=1}^N$

Ref: A. Khan and S. Li, CNC-Inspired Robotic Hair Cutting: A Comprehensive Survey on Precision Personal Care Automation, Journal of Artificial Intelligence for Automation

Mobile Robotics Perspective



FIGURE 1 Analogy between robotic lawn mowing and robotic haircutting, highlighting the natural extension of mobile robot techniques from grass mowing to hair trimming.



Continuous data collection creates a virtuous cycle of improvement.



Haircut

Motion & Sensor Data



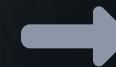
Feedback

Ratings & Reviews



Training

ML Model
Improvement



Better Service

Enhanced Accuracy

The background is a dark, deep blue space scene. In the lower right, a bright, glowing arc represents the horizon of a planet, with a textured surface visible. Scattered throughout the dark space are numerous small, white stars of varying brightness. In the upper left, a portion of a dark, curved object, possibly a satellite or part of a spacecraft, is visible.

05

Safety & Security

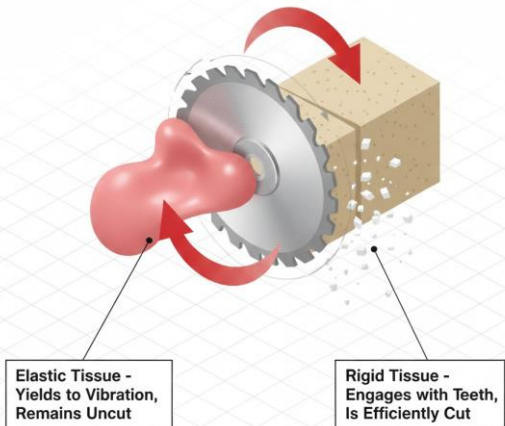
Safety Certification

Ensuring client safety is the top priority, requiring a multi-layered approach to mitigate risks.



Sharp Tools: Use safer alternatives like clippers.

Selective Cutting Principle



Safety Certification

Ensuring client safety is the top priority, requiring a multi-layered approach to mitigate risks.

TABLE 2 Categorization of risks in haircutting robots across system aspects

Risk category	Typical issues	Associated components
Network & cybersecurity	• High latency in teleoperation causing delayed reaction • Network congestion leading to packet loss • Cyberattacks that hijack robot control • Unauthorized modification of haircut trajectory • Service interruption from unstable wireless connection	Communication link, wireless modules, teleoperation interface, network protocols
Perception & sensing	• Misclassification of hair, skin, or ear boundaries • Depth camera errors due to lighting or occlusion • Force/torque sensor drift or calibration failure • Loss of vibration or acoustic signals during tool–hair interaction • Single-sensor dependency without redundancy	Cameras, depth sensors, force/torque sensors, acoustic/vibration sensors, sensor fusion modules
Physical & tool-related	• Excessive contact force from clippers or scissors • Unsafe blade geometry causing skin injury • Overheating of dryers or curlers near scalp • Accidental collision with robot arm or end-effector • Tool wear leading to irregular performance	Clippers, scissors, heating tools (dryer/curler), blade geometry, robotic arm end-effector
Control & algorithmic	• Instability of controller under time delay • Unsafe motion planning without safety margins • Lack of fallback strategies when sensors fail • Runtime monitoring failure to stop hazardous action • Inconsistent tool switching logic	Motion planner, obstacle avoidance module, controller, runtime safety monitor, tool-switching logic
Human-related	• Sudden head movements (rotation, tilting, reflexes) • Postural shifts due to discomfort or fatigue • Fear or psychological stress during close contact • Non-cooperation or unexpected user actions • Lack of trust or acceptance of robotic haircutting	User head, posture, facial regions (ear/neck), behavioral response, psychological state



Sharp Tools: Use safer alternatives like clippers.



Excessive Force: Implement soft, compliant materials.



Sensor Failure: Use redundant sensor systems.



Cybersecurity: Employ local safety monitors.

Z. Huang, A. Vilkki, S. Li and J. Röning, Safety in Robotic Haircutting, Under 2nd round of review in Journal of Field Robotics

Safety Certification

Ensuring client safety is the top priority, requiring a multi-layered approach to mitigate risks.

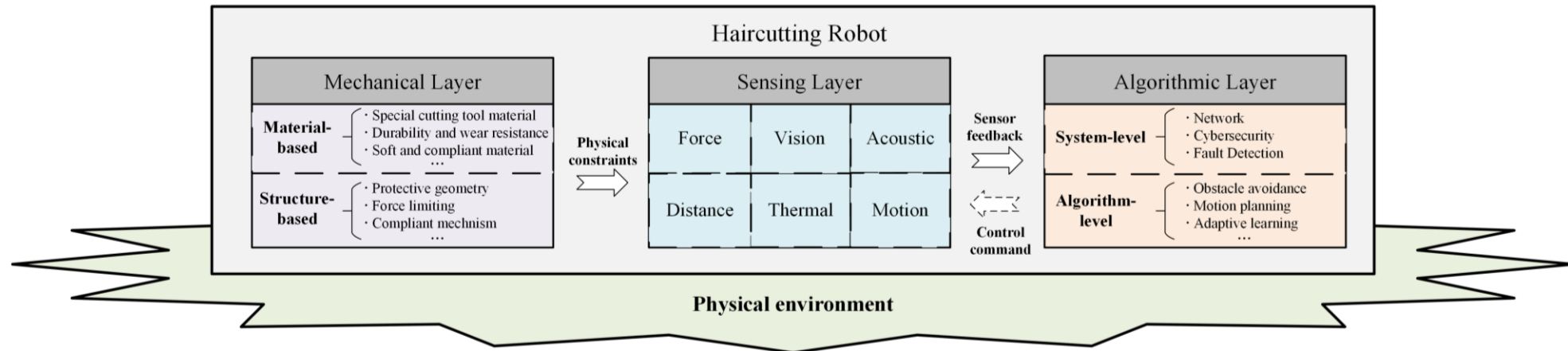


FIGURE 3 Three-layer safety framework for haircutting robots with layer-wise components



Sharp Tools: Use safer alternatives like clippers.



Sensor Failure: Use redundant sensor systems.



Excessive Force: Implement soft, compliant materials.



Cybersecurity: Employ local safety monitors.

Safety Certification

Ensuring client safety is the top priority, requiring a multi-layered approach to mitigate risks.

Supervised Autonomy Model



Cybersecurity: Employ local safety monitors.

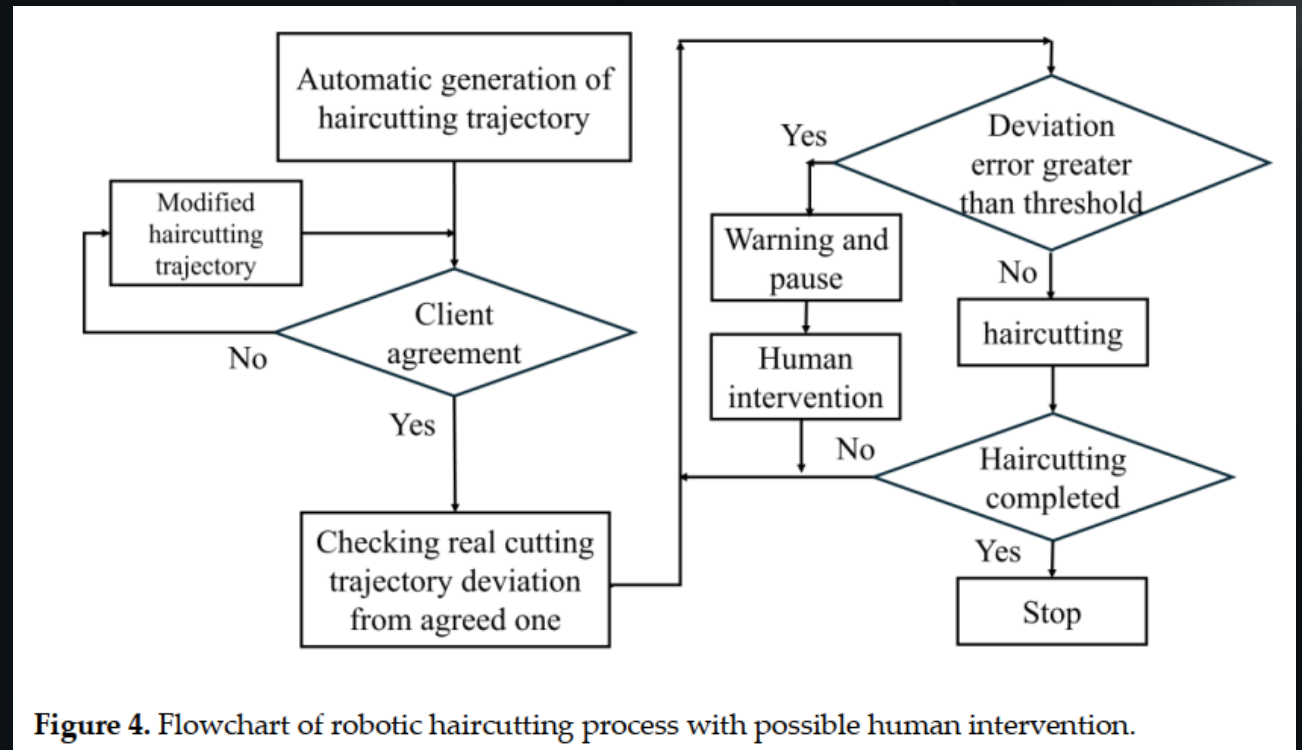
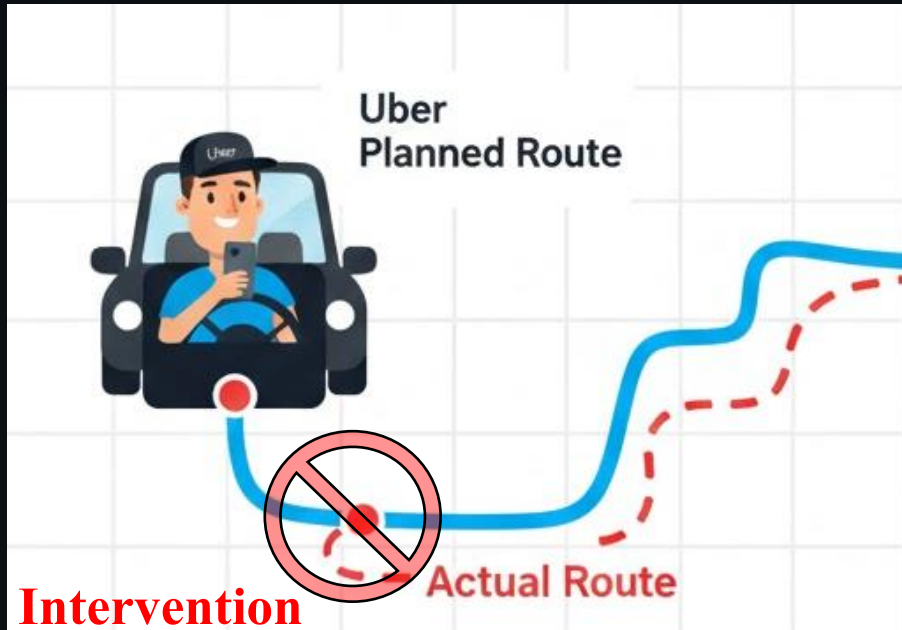


Figure 4. Flowchart of robotic haircutting process with possible human intervention.

Intervention is triggered by deviations, safety alerts, obstacles, or requests.

Supervised Autonomy Model

Full autonomy is deferred in favor of a practical model where one barber oversees multiple robots.



The background is a dark, deep space scene. In the upper left, a portion of a planet with rings is visible. In the lower right, a large, bright, curved horizon of a planet dominates the frame. The background is filled with numerous small, distant stars.

06

Empowering Technologies

Empowering Tech: Drive & AI



Direct Drive Technology

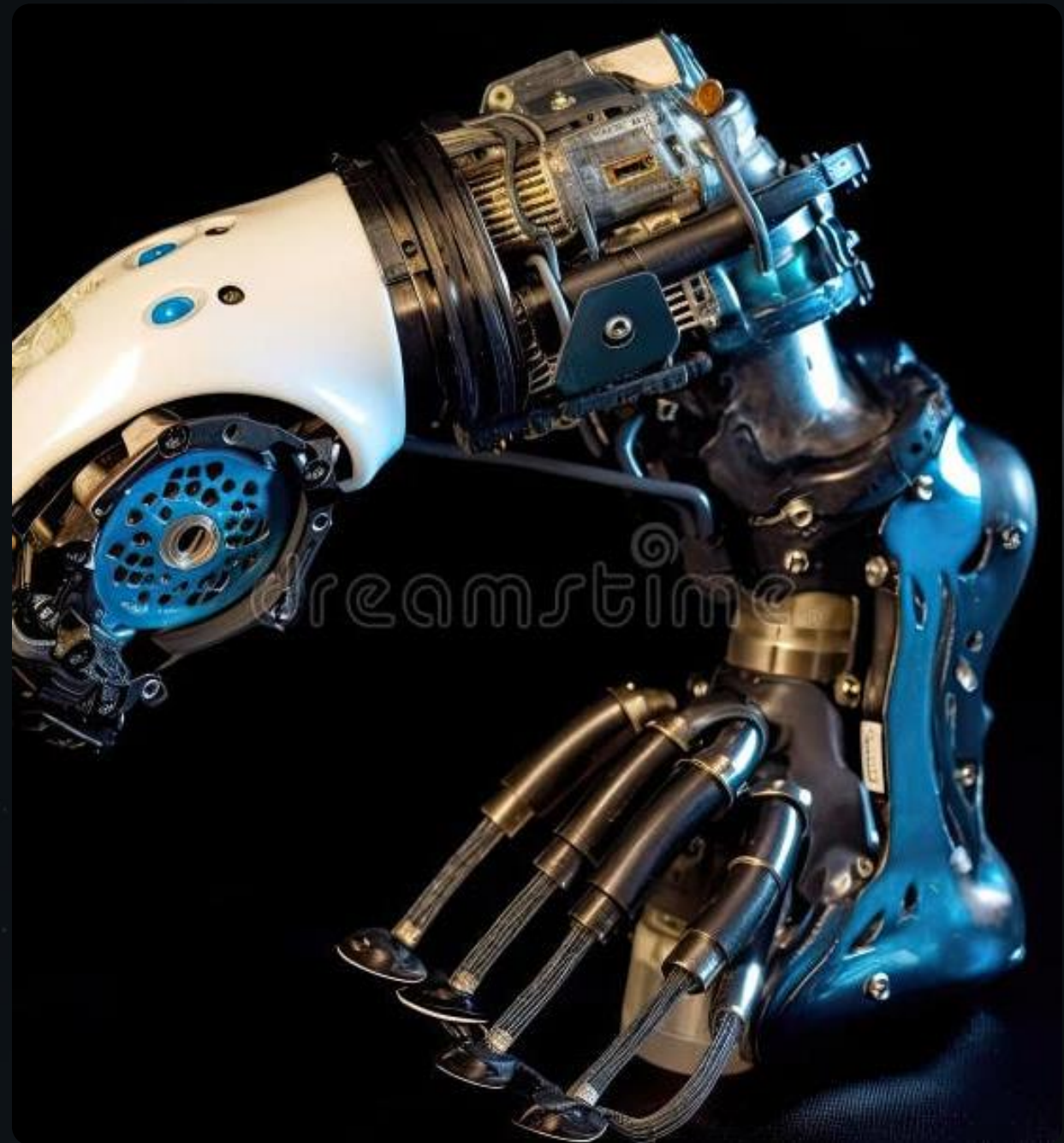
Provides **precise, backlash-free motion** crucial for intricate cuts and real-time head movement compensation.



Large Language Models (AI)

Offer **conversational companionship** and personalized style advice, enhancing the customer experience.

Ref. S. Li, Book: Haircutting Robots, Springer.



Empowering Tech: Immersion & Touch



Virtual Reality (VR)

Immerses remote barbers in the client's environment for precise assessment and control.



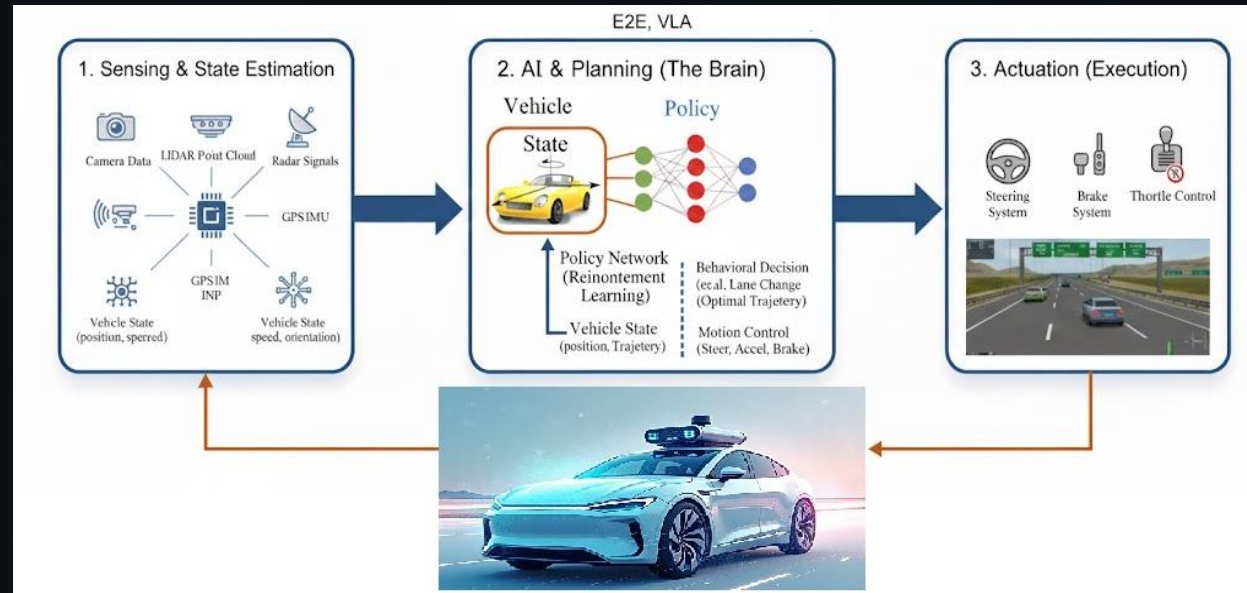
Force Control and Haptic Feedback

Allows operators to feel cutting forces, enabling fine control and a safer experience.

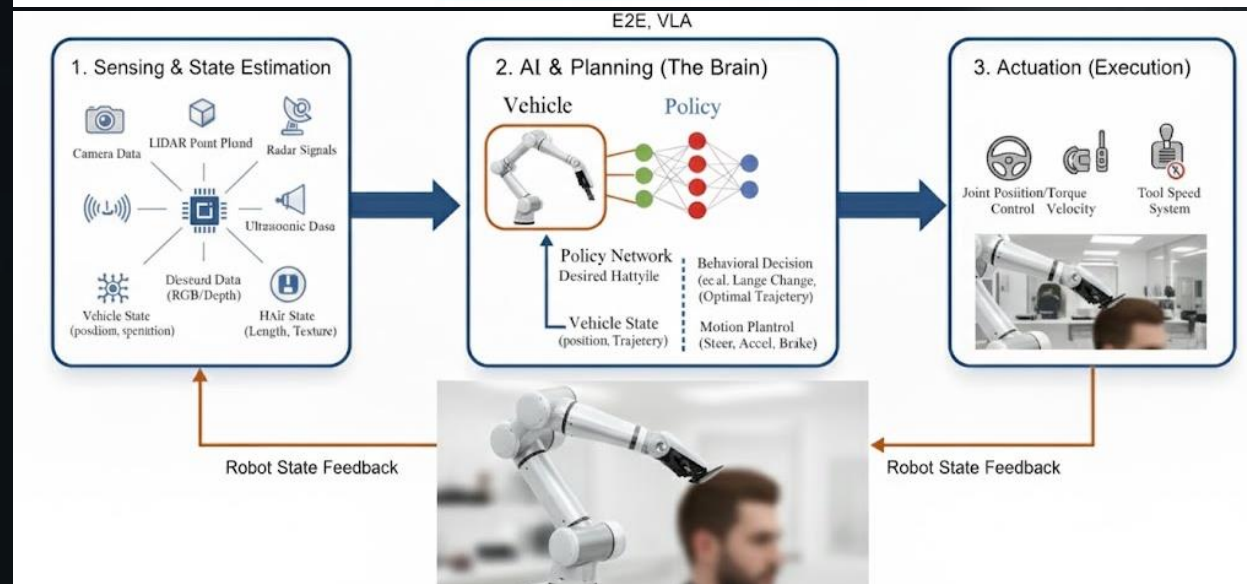
Ref. S. Li, Book: Haircutting Robots, Springer.

Empowering Tech: E2E, VLA, Imitation Learning

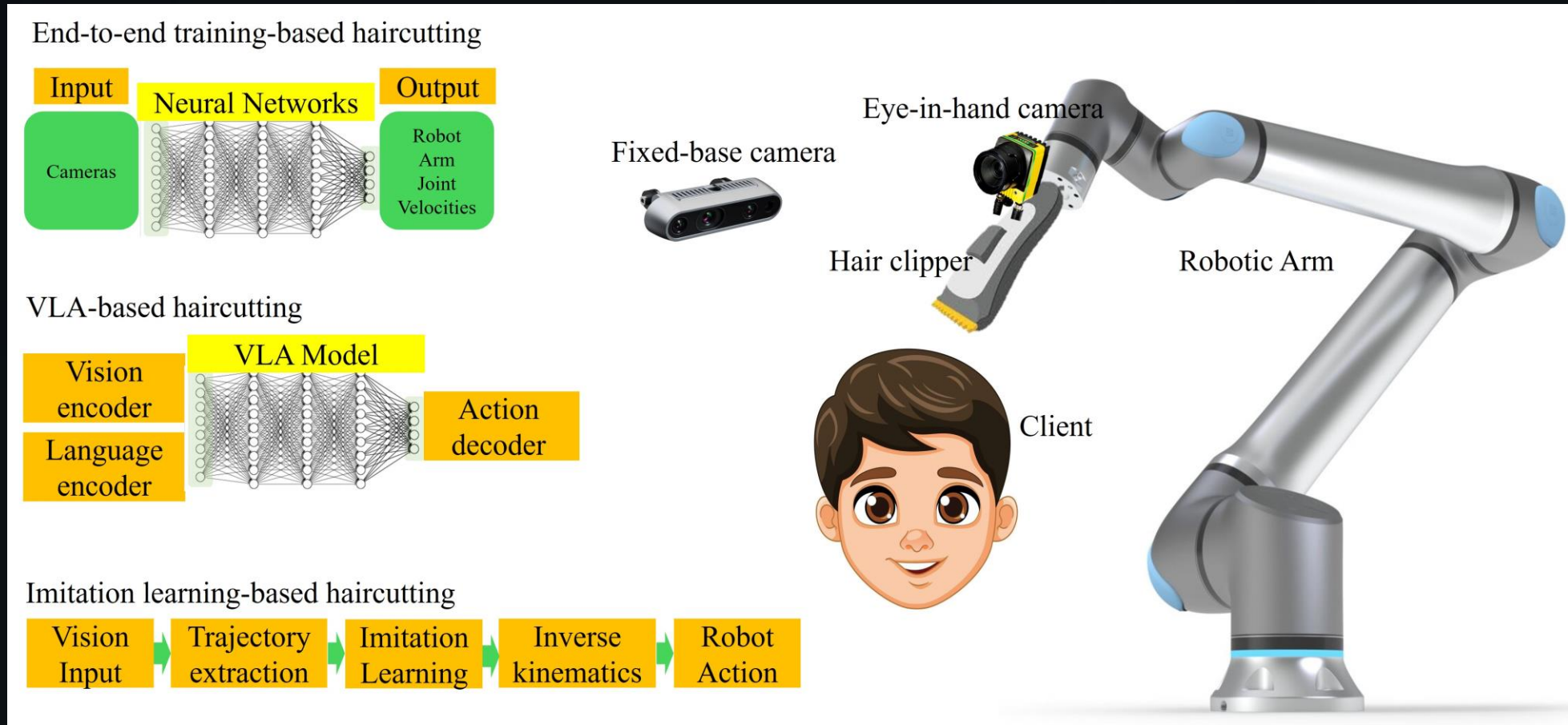
Autonomous Driving



Autonomous Haircutting

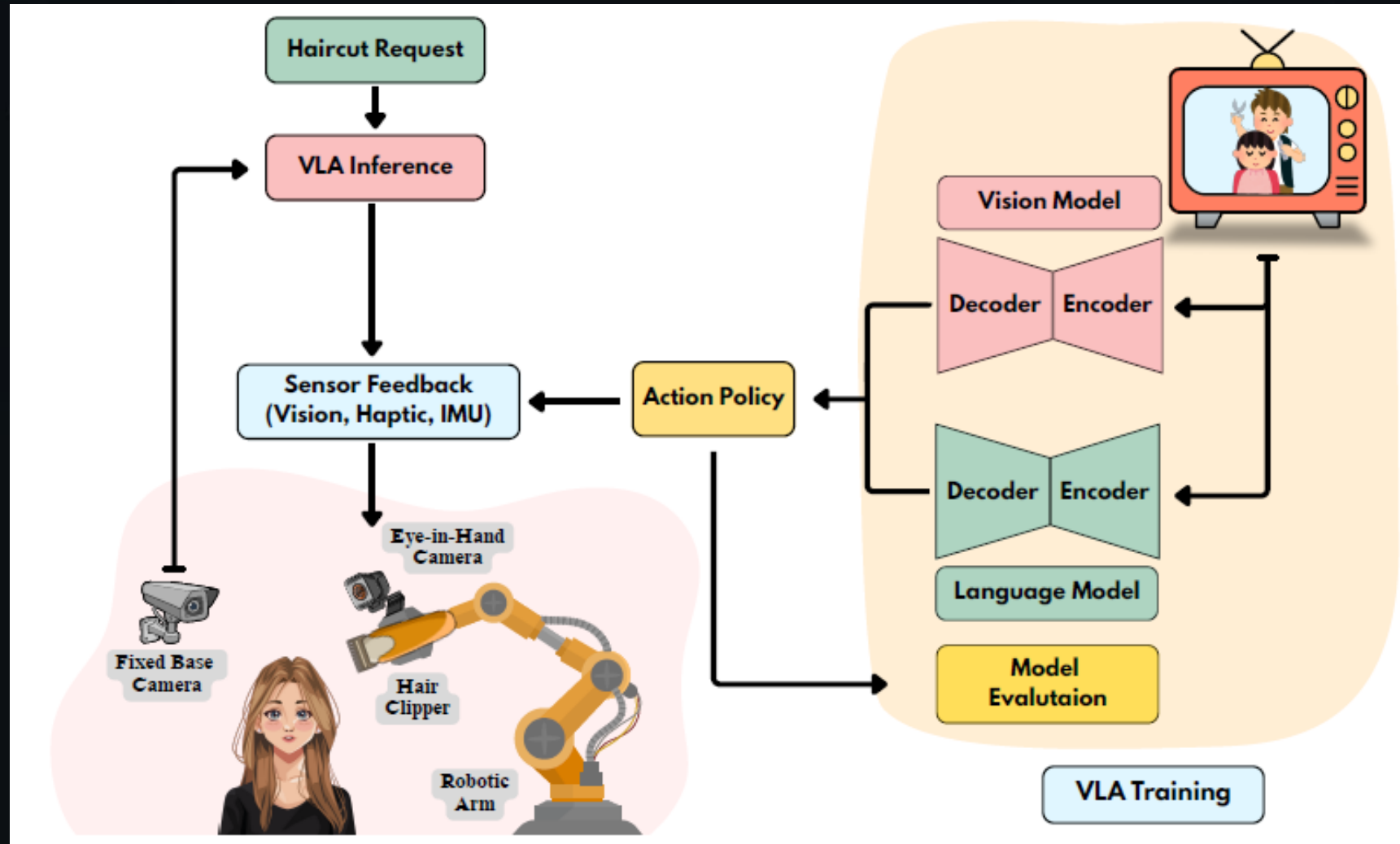


Empowering Tech: E2E, VLA, Imitation



Ref: A. Khan and S. Li, Vision-Language-Action Models for Intelligent Haircutting Robots: A Position Paper on Architectures, Evaluation, and Future Directions, Submitted.

Empowering Tech: E2E, VLA, Imitation



Ref: A. Khan and S. Li, Vision-Language-Action Models for Intelligent Haircutting Robots: A Position Paper on Architectures, Evaluation, and Future Directions, Submitted.

Core Supporting Technology for Haircutting Robots

Perception Layer

- 3D Visual Modeling (Structured Light)
- Force/Tactile Sensing (Anti-scratch)
- Hair Feature Recognition (Hardness/Density)

Decision & Algorithm

- AI Hairstyle Design (Face Shape Matching)
- Motion Path Planning (Obstacle Avoidance)
- Intelligent Control (PID, Deep Learning)

Execution Layer

- Multi-DOF Robotic Arm (6/7-axis)
- End Effector (Electric Clipper, Scissors)
- Direct Drive Servo (High Precision)

HCI Layer

- Voice/Gesture Control Interaction
- AR Hairstyle Preview & Try-on
- Remote Control & Real-time Monitoring

Safety & Reliability

- Collision Emergency Stop & Force Limit
- Power/Network Failure Safe Return
- Fault Detection & Predictive Maintenance

Testing & Industrialization

- Function/Performance/Safety Testing
- Modular Design & Mass Production
- Business Model & Industry Standards

This six-layer closed-loop system integrates interdisciplinary technologies, enabling fully automated and safe haircut services.

I. Perception Layer: Environment & Human Understanding

Core Objective: Achieve precise recognition and understanding of the head, hairstyle, and environment.



3D Visual Modeling

Tech: Structured Light, ToF, LiDAR

Func: Reconstruct head model, extract hair contours/lengths for path planning.

Challenges: Real-time dynamic modeling, lighting robustness.



Force & Tactile Sensing

Tech: 6-axis Force Sensors, Tactile Arrays

Func: Detect contact force, enable feedback control for safety & comfort.

Challenges: Sensor durability, real-time signal processing.



Hair Feature Perception

Tech: High-speed Cameras, Spectral Analysis

Func: Identify hardness, curliness, density for personalized cutting.

Challenges: Non-contact, fast & accurate analysis.

Summary: The Perception Layer acts as the robot's 'eyes' and 'skin'. It integrates multi-sensor data to create a precise digital twin of the user's head, enabling the system to make intelligent, safe, and personalized decisions during the haircut process.

II. Decision & Algorithm Layer: The Intelligent Brain

Core Objective: Intelligently plan and control the entire haircut process based on perception data.



AI Hairstyle Design

Tech: CV face analysis, golden ratio models, hairstyle DB.

Func: Recommends style via AR/VR preview; generates digital target model.

Chall: Quantifying aesthetics, satisfying personalized needs.



Motion & Path Planning

Tech: Inverse kinematics, RRT*, trajectory optimization.

Func: Plans collision-free paths for arm to reach target positions accurately.

Chall: High-redundancy path optimization, dynamic obstacle avoidance.



Intelligent Control

Tech: PID, adaptive control, sliding mode control, RL.

Func: Precisely controls force/speed; learns to optimize cutting strategies.

Chall: High-dynamic real-time response, robustness in complexity.

This layer acts as the intellectual core, translating visual data into actionable, precise robotic movements through advanced computational intelligence.

III. Execution Layer: Mechanics & Haircut Operation

Core Objective: Precisely and stably execute haircutting actions



Mechanical Body Design

Tech: 6/7-axis robotic arms, lightweight materials, high-precision reducers.

Func: Full head coverage, obstacle avoidance, compliant operation.

Chall: Balancing precision, payload, and compactness.



End Effector (Tool)

Tech: Integrated clippers, scissors, combs with auto-adjustment.

Func: Trimming, thinning, styling; anti-hair-pinching safety.

Chall: Miniaturization, reliability, and quick tool change.



Drive System

Tech: High-precision servo motors, direct-drive, harmonic drives.

Func: Power movement, ensure precise control & fast response.

Chall: System efficiency, low noise, and long-term stability.

Translating decisions into precise physical movements with industrial-grade accuracy.

Human-Computer Interaction Layer

Core Objective: Achieve a convenient, intuitive, and user-friendly interaction experience.



Interaction Methods

Technologies: Speech recognition, computer vision gesture recognition, HD touch screens.

Function: Control robot via voice, gestures or touch. NLP enables fluent, humanized interaction.

Challenges: Accuracy in complex environments, gesture robustness, logic simplicity.



Visual Interaction

Technologies: AR/VR, 3D rendering engines.

Function: Visualize virtual hairstyles on user's head pre-cut. Display real-time progress.

Challenges: Accurate virtual-real matching, real-time rendering efficiency.



Remote Interaction

Technologies: IoT, 5G communication, remote control software.

Function: Remote booking, status monitoring, and expert remote guidance for complex styles.

Challenges: Low-latency control, network security & privacy.

The Human-Computer Interaction Layer bridges the gap between user intent and robotic execution. By integrating advanced perception and visualization technologies, we aim to make the haircutting process not just automated, but truly intelligent and empathetic.

V. Safety & Reliability Layer: Bottom-line Guarantee

Core Objective: Ensure absolute safety during the haircut and stable and reliable system operation.



Safety Mechanisms

Technologies: Emergency stop, collision detection, force feedback, safety light curtains.

Function: Multi-redundancy system. Immediate stop on abnormal force or collision. Electrical safety design.

Challenges: Fast response, avoiding false triggers.



Reliability Design

Technologies: Fault diagnosis, sensor redundancy, modular design, thermal management.

Function: Real-time monitoring, failure prediction, proactive maintenance, high availability.

Challenges: Complex system failure analysis, predictive accuracy.



Compliance & Ethics

Technologies: Data encryption, access control, privacy protocols.

Function: Strict protection of facial/hairstyle data. Compliance with safety standards and norms.

Challenges: Balancing data utilization with privacy, adapting to regulations.

This layer serves as the foundation for user trust, ensuring that innovation never compromises on safety or privacy.

VI. Testing & Industrialization Layer: Commercialization Support

Core Objective: Drive technology from the laboratory to the market and achieve large-scale application.



Testing & Validation

Technologies: Simulation platforms, HIL testing, UX testing, reliability testing.

Function: Comprehensive pre-launch tests for safety and quality. Optimize results via real-user data.

Challenges: Scenario coverage, quantitative evaluation, rapid iteration.



Industrialization System

Technologies: Modular design, standardized processes, supply chain management.

Function: Reduce costs via modularization. Ensure consistency through quality control.

Challenges: Performance-cost balance, core component supply, production efficiency.



Business & Ecosystem

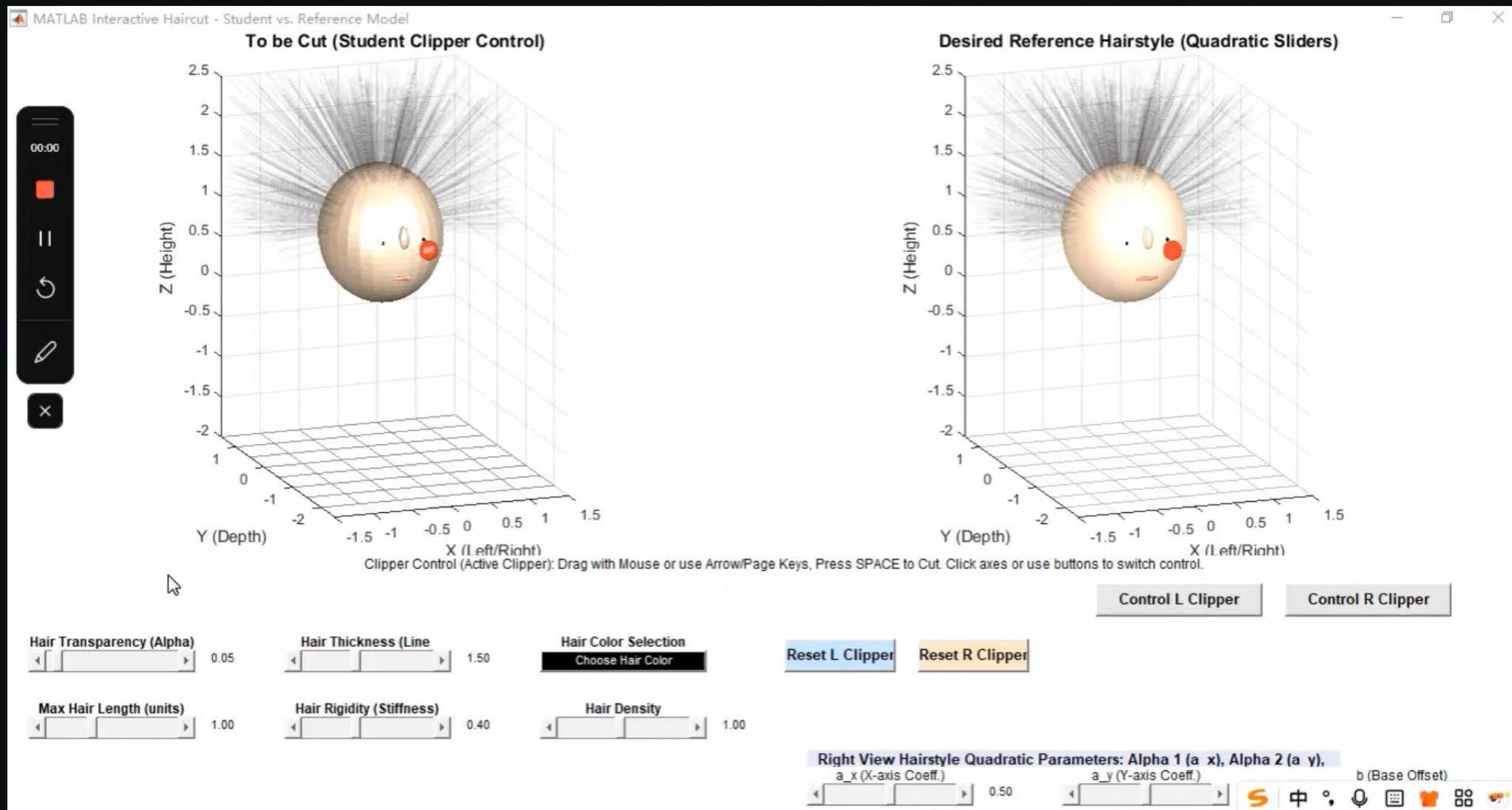
Technologies: IoT platforms, big data analytics, membership systems.

Function: Explore sales/leasing models. Build ecosystem via data analysis.

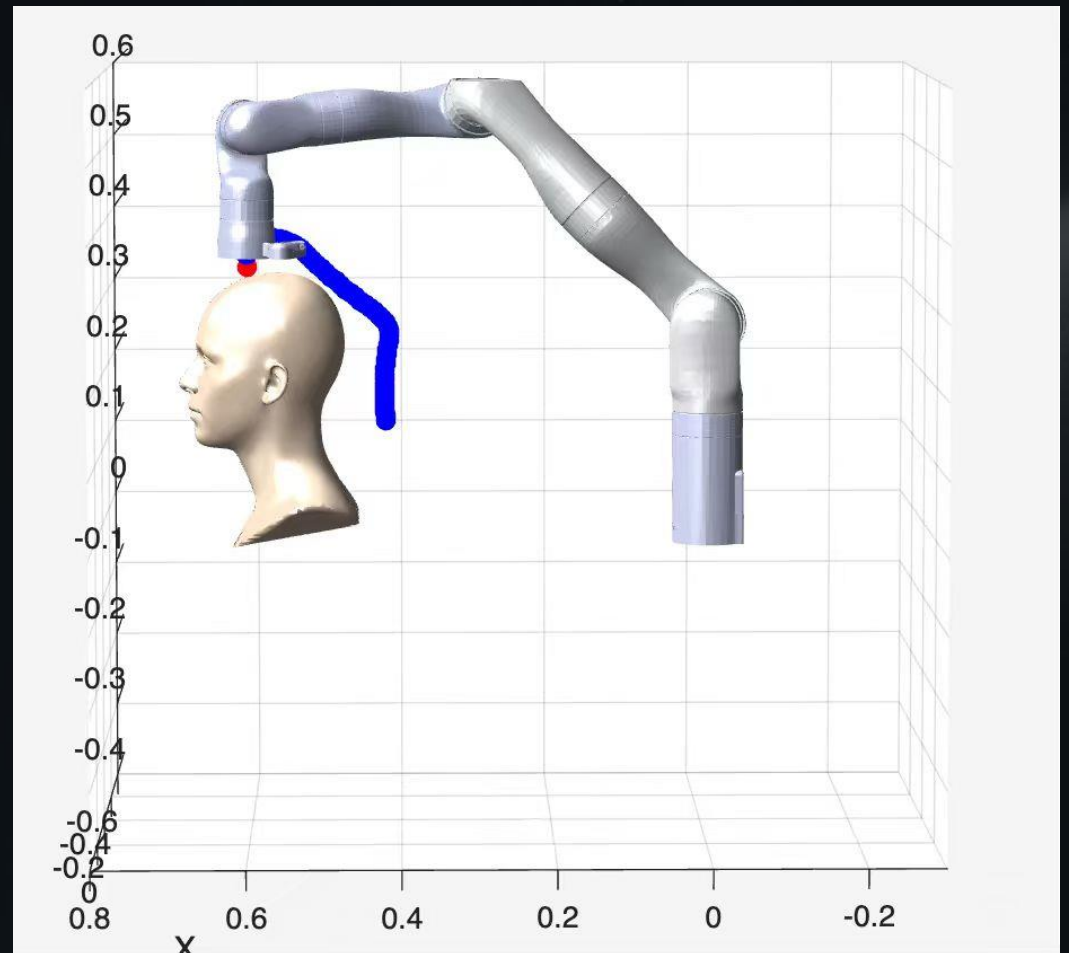
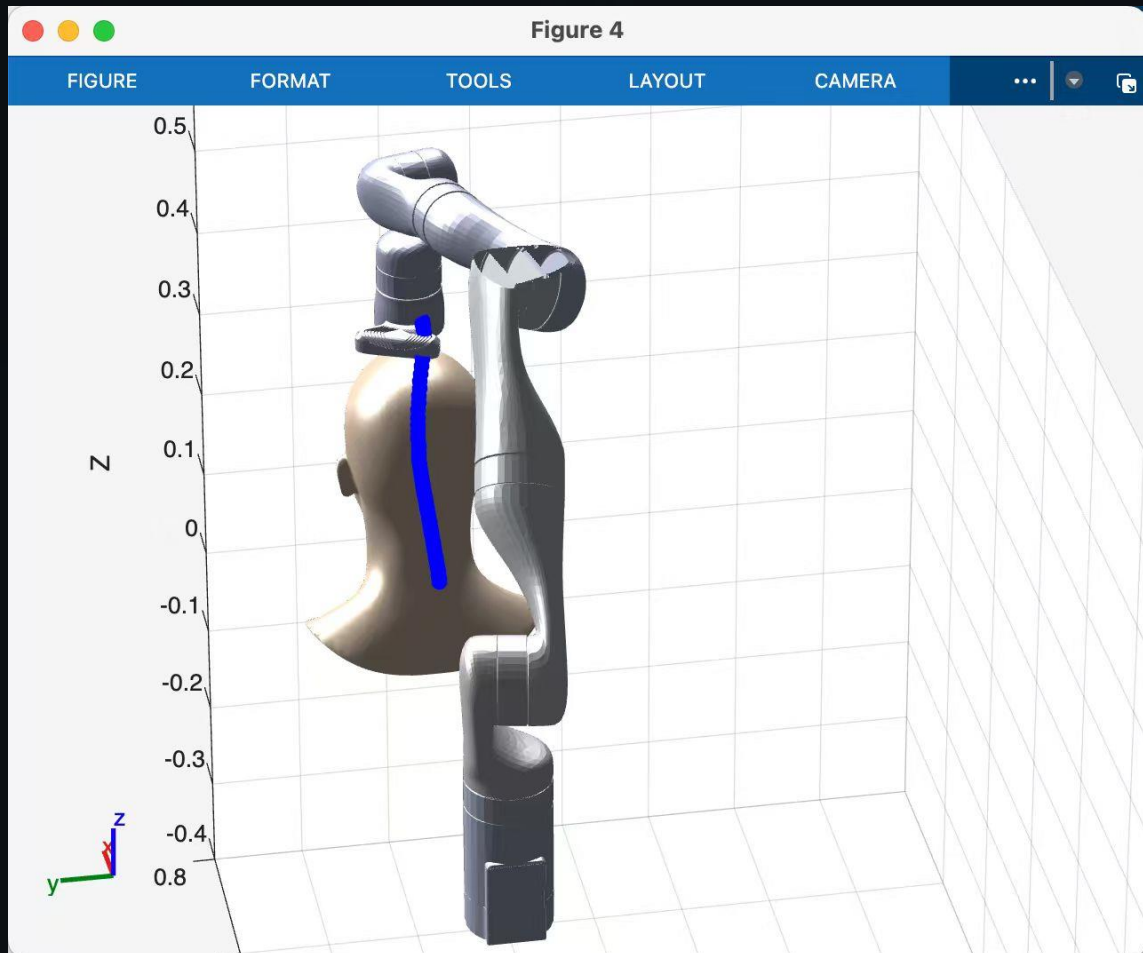
Challenges: Sustainable profit, user trust, industry standard formulation.

This layer serves as the bridge connecting technological innovation with market reality, ensuring scalability and profitability.

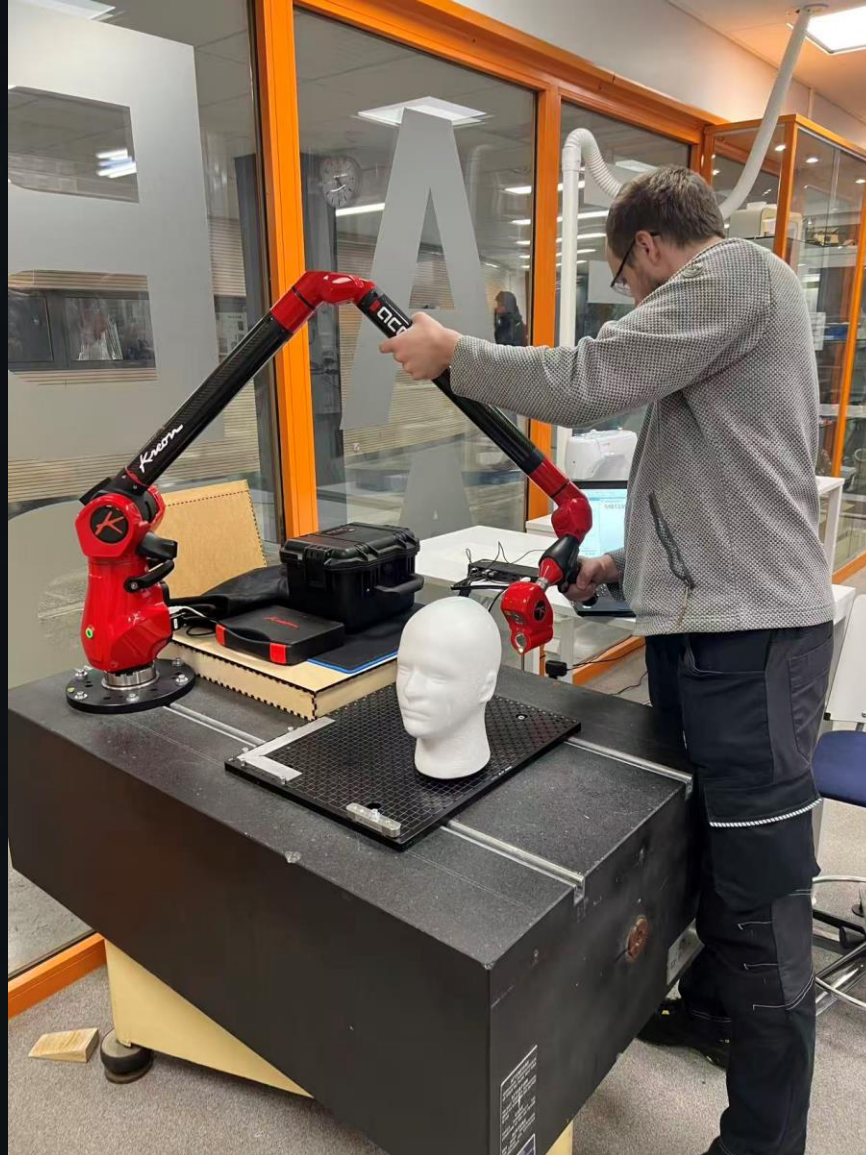
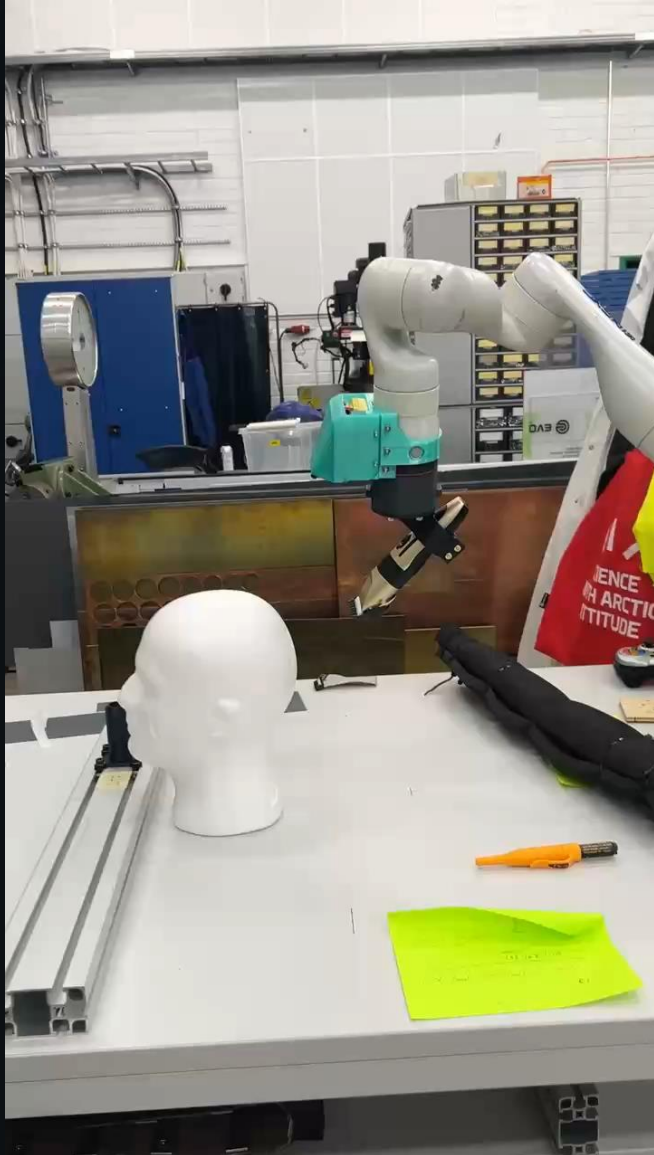
Preliminary Results: Hair Dynamics Simulator



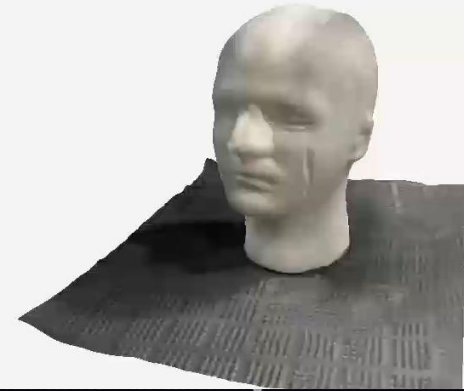
Preliminary Results: Haircutting Robot Simulator



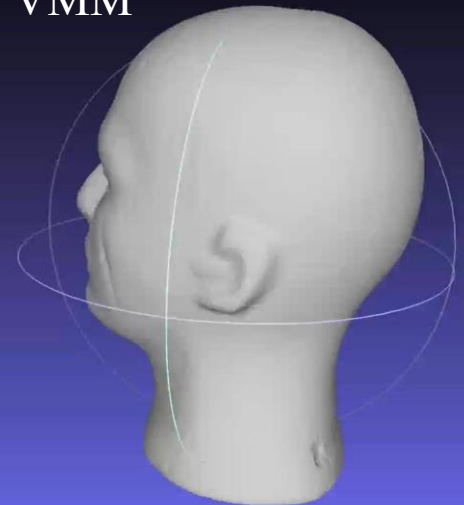
Preliminary Results: Experimental Systems



By Iphone Lidar

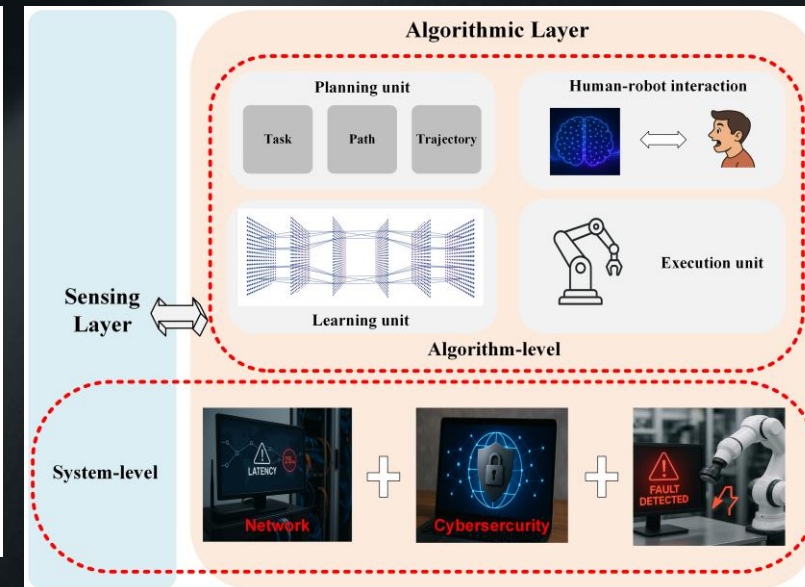
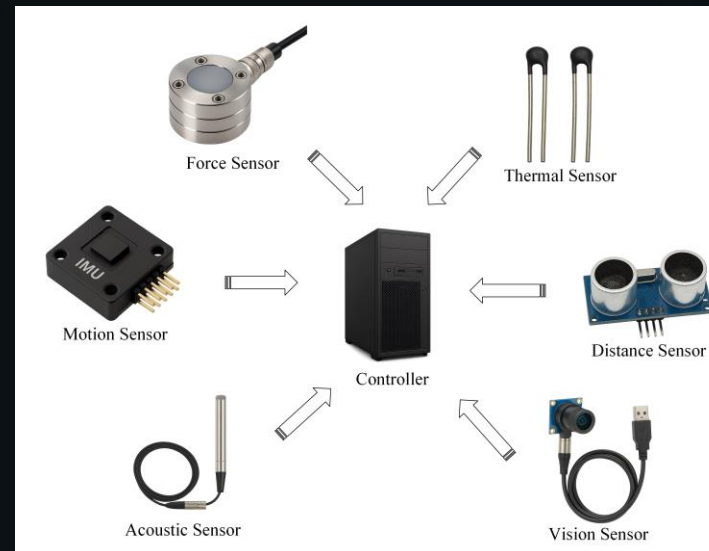
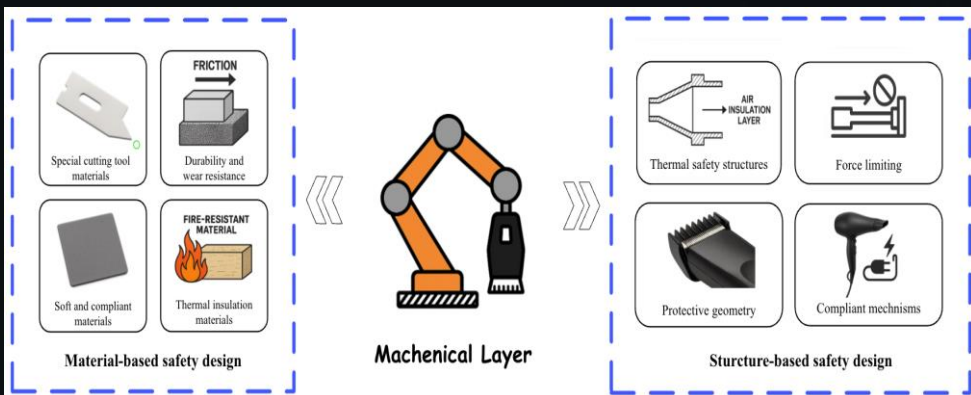
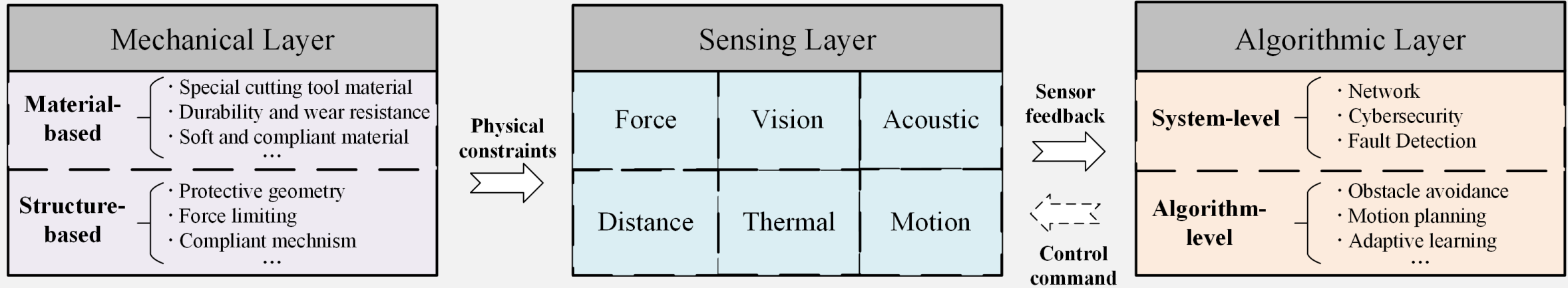


By VMM



Preliminary Results: Safety Mechanisms

Haircutting Robot



Preliminary Results: Safety Mechanisms

Mechanical Layer



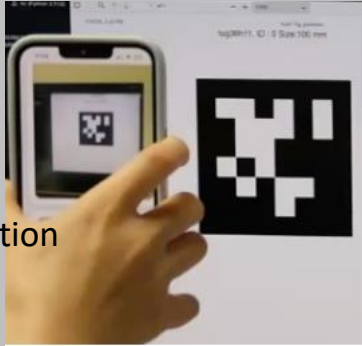
Hair Clipper

Z. Huang, A. Vilkkki, S. Li and J. Röning, Safety in Robotic Haircutting, Under 2nd round of review in Journal of Field Robotics

Remote Teleoperation Robotic Haircutting System

Master side

AprilTag pose estimation



pose signal

control command

Slave side

UR10e robotic arm

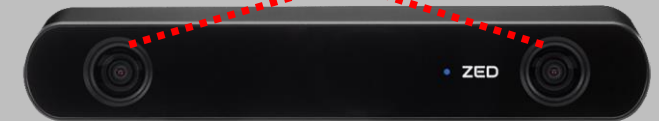


Vision side



Left-eye image

Right-eye image



ZED stereo camera

Binocular video

Binocular video



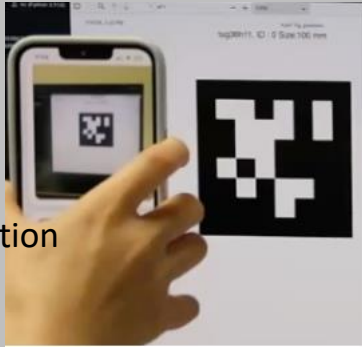
3D vision reconstruction



Preliminary Results: Teleoperation

Master side

AprilTag pose estimation



3D vision reconstruction

pose signal

control command



Binocular video

Binocular video

Slave side

UR10e robotic arm

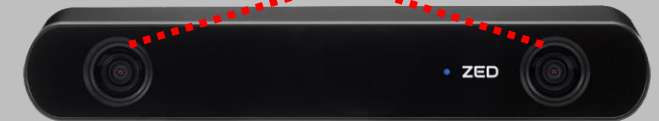


Vision side



Left-eye image

Right-eye image



ZED stereo camera

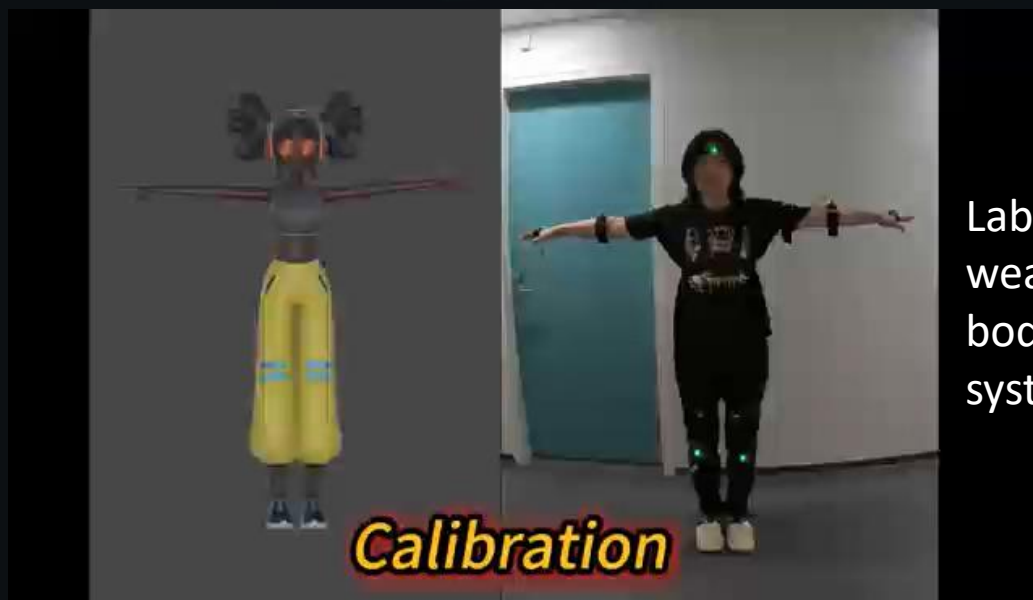
Preliminary Results: Teleoperation



Lab-made
wearable
body tracking
system for
dual arm
teleoperation



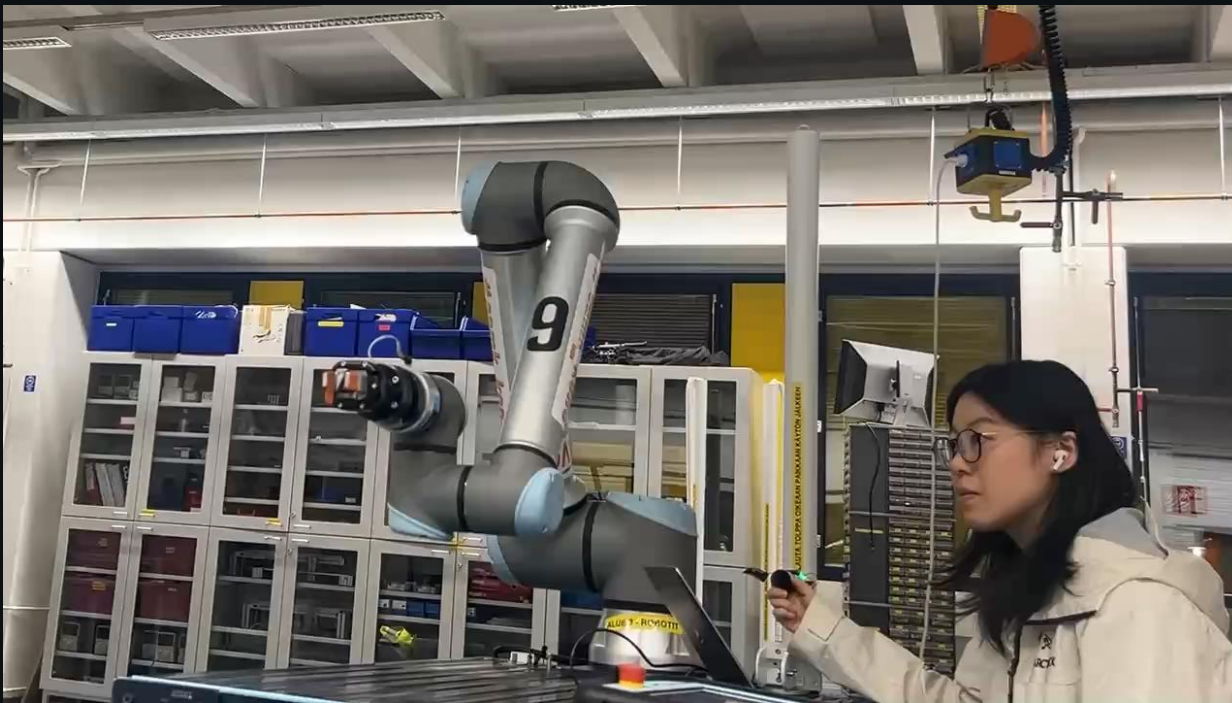
Lab-made
wearable
body tracking
system for
teleoperat
ed
haircutting



Lab-made
wearable
body tracking
system

Preliminary Results: Teleoperation

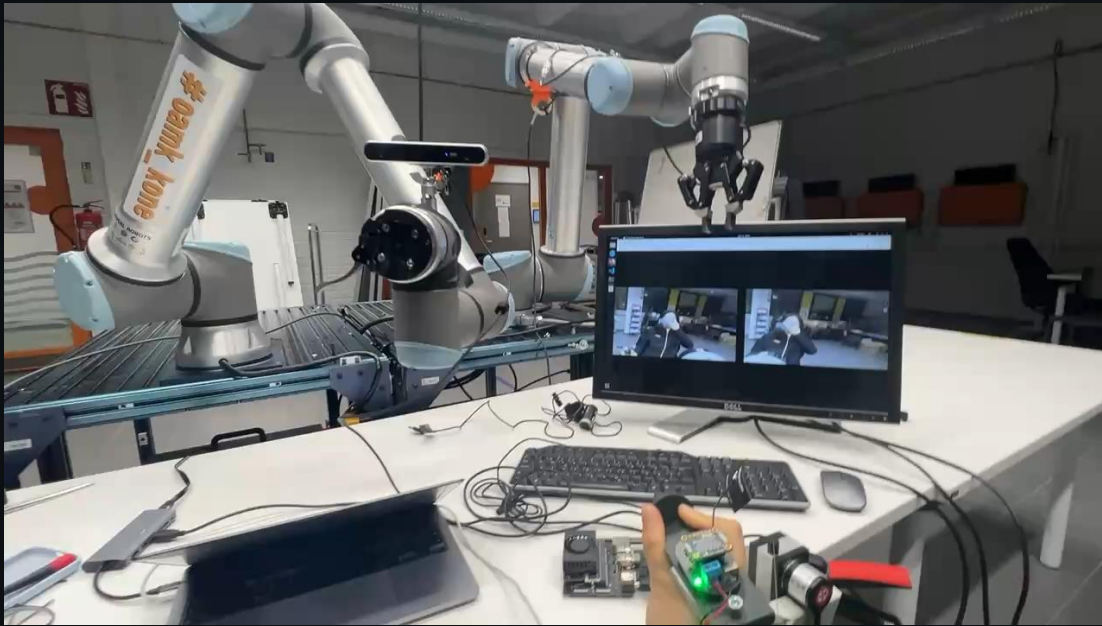
Lab-made control handle for teleoperated haircutting



Lab-made control handle (Cable CMM) for 6 DoF positioning (Ref. Z. Huang, Z. Chen, A. T. Khan, Y. Gan, F. Hu, J. Röning, and S. Li, A hybrid 6-DoF pose measurement system using string potentiometer and dual IMUs, 2025 IEEE International Workshop on Metrology for Sustainability, 2025)

Preliminary Results: Teleoperation

Experiments of Teleoperation in our lab.



Telehairing: an open accessible teleoperated
haircutting robot

Experiments of Teleoperation in our lab.

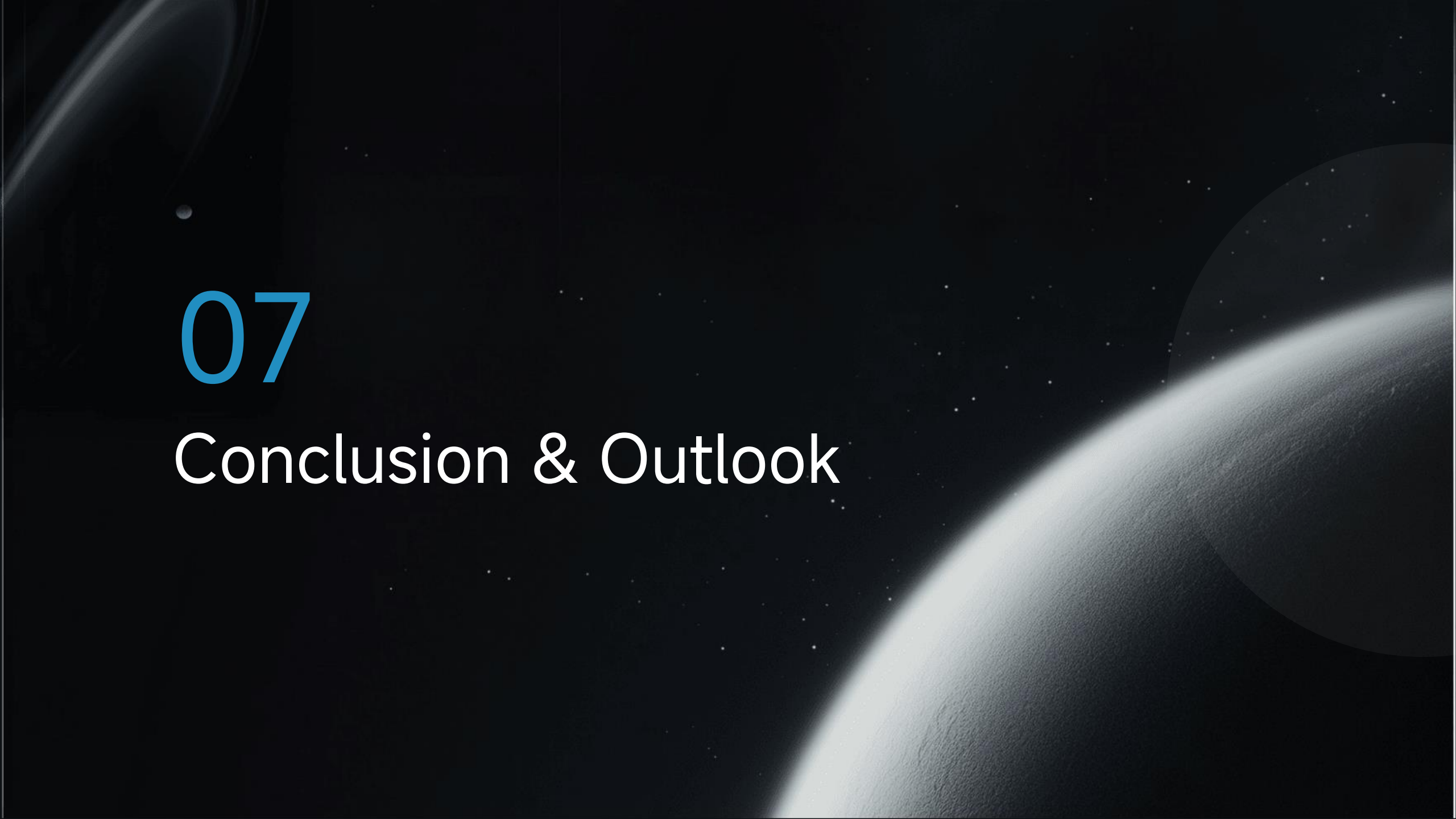
Preliminary Results: Teleoperation



Lab-made 6 DoF robotic arm using Xiaomi cybergear motors (Z. Chen, Z. Huang, Y. Gan, F. Hu, J. Röning, and S. Li, Development of a 6-DoF Robotic Manipulator with Smart Actuators and Real-Time Inverse Kinematics, ICNSC 2025.

Manipulability Optimization Control of a Serial Redundant Robot for Robot-assisted Minimally Invasive Surgery

Robotic surgery using self developed control algorithms (Ref. H. Su, S. Li, L. Bascetta, G. Ferrigno and Elena. Momi, Manipulability Optimization Control of a Serial Redundant Robot for Robot-assisted Minimally Invasive Surgery, ICRA 2019.)

A dark space background featuring a large, bright, curved horizon of a planet or moon on the right side. In the upper left, there is a faint, glowing ringed planet. The background is filled with numerous small, distant stars.

07

Conclusion & Outlook

Key Takeaways



Convergence of Tech

Cheaper robots, rising labor costs, and advanced AI are creating a perfect storm for automation.



Practical Deployment

Supervised autonomy and robust safety engineering are the keys to early commercialization.



Massive Market

A multi-faceted digital platform approach unlocks a global market worth hundreds of billions.

References

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- Khan and S. Li Robotic Haircutting Systems: A Survey of Methods, Challenges, and Hair Modeling Insights, IEEE Journal of Selected Areas in Sensors, 2026.
- A. Khan and S. Li, CNC-Inspired Robotic Hair Cutting: A Comprehensive Survey on Precision Personal Care Automation, Journal of Artificial Intelligence for Automation, 2026.
- Z. Chen, Z. Huang, Y. Gan, F. Hu, J. Röning, and S. Li, Development of a 6-DoF Robotic Manipulator with Smart Actuators and Real-Time Inverse Kinematics, ICNSC 2025
- H. Su, S. Li, L. Bascetta, G. Ferrigno and Elena. Momi, Manipulability Optimization Control of a Serial Redundant Robot for Robot-assisted Minimally Invasive Surgery, ICRA 2019.
- Z. Huang, Z. Chen, A. T. Khan, Y. Gan, F. Hu, J. Röning, and S. Li, A hybrid 6-DoF pose measurement system using string potentiometer and dual IMUs, 2025 IEEE International Workshop on Metrology for Sustainability, 2025
- Z. Huang, A. Vilkki, S. Li and J. Röning, Safety in Robotic Haircutting, under revision in Journal of Field Robotics
- A. Khan and S. Li, Vision-Language-Action Models for Intelligent Haircutting Robots: A Position Paper on Architectures, Evaluation, and Future Directions, Submitted.
- Z. Huang, A. Khan and S. Li, Haircutting Robots: A Mobile Robotics Perspective, under revision in International Journal of System Sciences.



Questions or Comments

Thanks!